SHH! (queers in libraries)

by bug tourmaline

This zine is based on work I did for my MSLIS, in Spring 2024.

linktree/bugtourmaline (for more zine stuff!)

Queers are scared of encountering both homophobia/transphobia and hetero/cis-sexism* when they work with professionals. This has mostly been studied re: doctors but also applies to librarians! Many people have library anxiety, but this kind is NOT unfounded, because queer people live with those threats every day. ~ (Kitzie, 2022; Schaller, 2011)

*Ab space for definitions. I recommend Googling it.

Education (like sexed) & educational materials (like books) on queer topics is INADEQUATE, so queer people turn to alternative sources (Jia, 2022).

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Fellow queer people are a trusted source of information, and there is a strong culture of sharing. (Dawn, 2021; Morris, 2016; Pohjanen, 2016; Schaller, 2011)

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The internet allows people to share & receive info while avoiding most discrimination (Jia, 2024; Jia, 2022).

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Queer people engage with entertainment media in four main ways: validation of their own queer experience, education for the media's accuracy, fact finding, and USING ITAS INSPIRATION FOR CREATIVE THEIR OWN QUEER MEDIA (Floegel, 2019.)

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RECOMMENDATIONS FOR LIBRARIANS

- Promote queer media in ways that protect privacy, like pamphlets & displays (Schaller, 2011).
- Provide resources, workshops, and technology needed for patrons to make zines, record podcasts & write fanfiction (Floegel, 2019)
- Install community bulletin boards (Schaller, 2011)

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SOURCES

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